From “It's a Lot” to One Clear Example

A worksheet for naming what has gotten harder.

“It's getting to be a lot” is hard for a family to answer. “I drove him to four appointments this month and I set out his pills every night” is something they can talk about.

Take one concern per sheet and put the date at the top. Write what happened, with the day, and keep what you saw apart from what you think it means. Where you'd be guessing, say so and leave it.

The worry, the way you'd say it out loud

Start with the general version, in your own words. Don't tidy it.

FOR EXAMPLE “I can't keep track of everything anymore.”

One time it happened

What happened, where, and on which day. One example is enough to begin. Add a second if it comes easily.

FOR EXAMPLE Thursday: his eye appointment and the pharmacy pickup were both at two. I took him to the appointment. The prescription waited until Saturday.

What you saw, and what you make of it

On the first lines, only what happened. Below them, what you think it means, marked as your own reading. Keep the two apart.

FOR EXAMPLE Saw: our son said he'd call the pharmacy on Monday. I called on Wednesday. My reading: it slipped his mind. I haven't asked him.

What it changed in his day

What was different for your husband because of it, if anything. If you're not sure, ask him and write what he says.

FOR EXAMPLE He waited in the car for forty minutes while I sorted out the pharmacy. He said he didn't mind.

What it took from your week

The time it took, and what you moved or set aside to fit it in. Plain facts, no apology.

FOR EXAMPLE About three hours on Thursday. I missed lunch with my sister, the second time this month.

What you don't know yet

The part you'd be guessing at. Leave it as a question.

FOR EXAMPLE Does our daughter know I do the pharmacy runs now? I've never told her.

What this shows you

One concern in a form someone else can answer: what happened, what you saw, what it changed for him and for you, and what you'd still be guessing at. It doesn't show whether the arrangement is working or whether anything should change. Nothing here adds up to a score or a level, and it is one concern, not the family's whole list.

Ready for the next step?

You've turned a general worry into an example someone can answer. The care interview takes it from there: it goes through your husband's situation and the help around him area by area, so the ordinary parts get written down too, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›